TITLE OF THE PROJECT

A Project Report submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of the degree of

Master of Computer Applications

by

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Declaration

I hereby declare that the work which is being presented in the M.C.A. Project **"Lost and found"**, in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of the ***Master of Computer Applications*** and submitted to the Department of Computer Engineering and Applications of GLA University, Mathura, is an authentic record of my own work carried under the supervision of **Mr Umakant Ahirwar (Assistant Professor).**

The contents of this project report, in full or in parts, have not been submitted to any other Institute or University for the award of any degree.

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Certificate

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Acknowledgement

I would like to express my deepest and most sincere gratitude to **Mr. Umakant Ahirwar**, my project supervisor, for his constant guidance, encouragement, and unwavering support throughout the development of my project, *"Lost & Found Management System."* His profound knowledge, insightful suggestions, and patient mentorship have been invaluable at every stage of this work. His ability to guide me through challenges and motivate me to improve continuously has played a crucial role in the successful completion of this project.

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Lastly, I acknowledge with gratitude the support of everyone who directly or indirectly contributed to the completion of this project.

Abstract

The Lost & Found Management System is a web-based application designed to address the inefficiencies and limitations associated with traditional methods of managing lost and found items in educational institutions. Conventional approaches, such as physical notice boards, manual registers, and informal communication channels, often lead to fragmented information, delayed recovery, and increased chances of item misuse. This project aims to overcome these challenges by providing a centralized, secure, and technology-driven platform that streamlines the entire lost-and-found lifecycle.

The system is developed using PHP as the backend technology, MySQL as the database, and HTML, CSS, and JavaScript for the frontend interface, all integrated within a XAMPP server environment. It follows a role-based architecture involving Students, Class Representatives (CRs), and Class Advisers, ensuring proper authorization, accountability, and structured workflow management. Each user role is assigned specific responsibilities, enabling efficient handling, verification, and approval of reported items.

The platform provides key functionalities such as item reporting, advanced search and filtering, and a centralized dashboard for real-time visibility of all entries. A major feature of the system is its automated status tracking mechanism, which manages the progression of items through different stages, including *Reported, Under Review, Approved, Claimed,* and *Returned*. This ensures transparency and allows users to monitor the status of their items at any time.

Additionally, the system incorporates a secure claim verification process, where users must provide valid proof or details to establish ownership before reclaiming an item. This significantly reduces the risk of false claims and enhances trust within the system. The application also maintains a digital record of all transactions and activities, creating a reliable audit trail for administrative purposes.

Testing and evaluation of the system demonstrate that it effectively reduces communication delays, minimizes manual effort, and improves the overall efficiency of item recovery. By digitizing and centralizing the process, the system not only enhances user convenience but also promotes honesty, responsibility, and accountability among students.

In conclusion, the Lost & Found Management System provides a scalable, cost-effective, and user-friendly solution for managing lost and found assets in academic environments. The project highlights the practical application of web technologies in solving real-world problems and can be further enhanced with advanced features such as mobile integration and notification systems in the future.

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Chapter 1
Introduction

1.1 Overview and Motivation

In educational institutions, the management of lost and found items is a frequent yet often inefficient and unorganized process. Students and staff regularly misplace personal belongings such as ID cards, books, electronic devices, and other valuables. Traditionally, information about such items is shared through physical notice boards, word-of-mouth communication, or informal digital channels like email groups and messaging platforms such as WhatsApp. However, these methods suffer from major limitations.

In today's digital environment, students are constantly exposed to a high volume of notifications, emails, and messages. Important information related to lost and found items often gets lost in this overload. Messages posted in WhatsApp groups or sent via email are quickly buried under continuous conversations or ignored due to message fatigue. Additionally, not all students are part of the same groups, and emails are frequently overlooked or marked as less important. As a result, critical information fails to reach the intended audience at the right time, significantly reducing the chances of item recovery.

Moreover, these traditional and informal methods lack structure, proper documentation, and verification mechanisms. There is no reliable way to track whether an item has been claimed, who claimed it, or whether the claim was legitimate. This not only causes delays but also increases the risk of misuse or loss of valuable items.

To address these challenges, there is a clear need for a centralized and structured digital solution. The **Lost & Found Management System** is designed to overcome these issues by providing a dedicated web-based platform for managing lost and found items. Unlike scattered communication channels, this system ensures that all information is stored in a single location, making it easily accessible, searchable, and trackable.

The system enables users to report lost or found items, search for relevant entries, and monitor their status in real time. It incorporates a role-based workflow involving Students, Class Representatives (CRs), and Class Advisers to ensure proper verification, approval, and accountability. By introducing secure claim verification, the system ensures that items are returned only to their rightful owners.

Overall, this project leverages web technologies to replace unreliable and fragmented communication methods with a structured, transparent, and efficient system. It not only improves the chances of recovering lost items but also reduces administrative burden and enhances trust within the campus environment

1.2 Problem Statement

Despite the presence of various communication channels such as notice boards, emails, and messaging platforms like WhatsApp, there is a significant lack of a structured and reliable system for managing lost and found items in educational institutions. These existing methods are informal, fragmented, and inefficient, leading to poor coordination and reduced chances of item recovery.

The following key problems have been identified in the existing system, which motivated the development of this project:

1. Unorganized Information Sharing: Lost and found information is scattered across multiple platforms such as WhatsApp groups, emails, and physical notice boards, making it difficult to track and manage effectively.
2. Message Overload and Ignorance: Important messages often get buried under continuous chats or are ignored due to excessive notifications, reducing visibility and chances of recovery.
3. Lack of Centralized System: There is no single platform where all lost and found items are recorded, leading to duplication of efforts and confusion among users.
4. No Proper Verification Mechanism: Existing methods do not include any secure way to verify ownership, increasing the risk of false claims and misuse of found items.
5. Absence of Tracking System: Users cannot track the status of their reported items, resulting in uncertainty and lack of transparency in the recovery process.
6. Manual and Time-Consuming Process: Handling lost and found items manually requires significant effort and coordination, making the process slow and inefficient.
7. Lack of Accountability: There is no clear record of who reported, verified, or claimed an item, leading to a lack of responsibility and trust in the system.

1.3 Objectives of the Project

The primary objective of this project is to develop a robust web-based application that addresses the inefficiencies of traditional lost-and-found systems. The Lost & Found Management System aims to provide a structured, secure, and user-friendly platform for managing lost items within an educational institution. The specific aims are:

1. To Ensure Centralization & Organization: Create a unified platform where all lost and found items are recorded and managed systematically, eliminating scattered communication through notice boards, emails, and messaging groups.

2. To Simplify Reporting Process: Enable users to easily report lost or found items by providing relevant details such as description, category, date, and location, ensuring quick and accurate data entry.

3. To Enable Efficient Search & Retrieval: Implement advanced search and filtering options that allow users to quickly find items based on keywords, categories, or dates.

4. To Provide Real-Time Tracking: Introduce an automated status tracking system that monitors item progress from *Reported* → *Under Review* → *Approved* → *Claimed* → *Returned*, ensuring transparency.

5. To Ensure Secure Claim Verification: Develop a verification mechanism where users must provide valid proof of ownership before claiming an item, reducing the chances of misuse or false claims.

6. To Implement Role-Based Access Control: Define clear roles for Students, Class Representatives (CRs), and Class Advisers to ensure proper authorization, accountability, and workflow management.

7. To Reduce Communication Gaps: Replace unreliable methods like WhatsApp groups and emails with a dedicated system that ensures important information is visible and not lost in message overload.

8. To Maintain Digital Records & Transparency: Store all activities and transactions in a database, creating a reliable history for tracking and administrative purposes.

9. To Promote Responsibility & Trust: Encourage honesty among users by providing a transparent and secure system that ensures fair handling and return of items.

1.4 Summary of Similar Applications

In the current scenario, lost and found information in educational institutions is mainly managed through informal and fragmented methods such as WhatsApp groups, email communication, and physical notice boards. While these methods are widely used, they lack structure, reliability, and efficiency. A comparison of these existing approaches with the proposed **Lost & Found Management System** highlights their limitations:

1.5 Comparison Table

Feature	WhatsApp Groups	Email System	Our System
Information Organization	Unstructured	Semi-structured	Fully centralized & organized
Visibility of Posts	Lost in chats	Often ignored/spam	Dedicated dashboard
Search Functionality	Limited	Basic	Advanced search & filters
Real-Time Tracking	Not available	Not available	Yes (status tracking)
Claim Verification	No	No	Secure verification
User Roles	Not defined	Not defined	Role-based (Student, CR, Adviser)

The comparison clearly shows that existing methods are not designed for structured lost-and-found management. They suffer from issues such as poor visibility, lack of tracking, and absence of verification mechanisms.

In contrast, the proposed system provides a **centralized, secure, and efficient platform** that integrates all essential features required for proper management of lost and found items. It ensures better organization, improved communication, and reliable item recovery through a systematic and technology-driven approach.

1.6 Organization of the Project

The project report for the Lost & Found Management System is systematically organized into different chapters to ensure a clear understanding of the problem, solution, design, and implementation. Each chapter focuses on a specific aspect of the project and is structured as follows:

- Chapter 1: Introduction
  This chapter provides an overview of the project, including motivation, problem statement, objectives, and a summary of existing systems.
- Chapter 2: System Analysis
  This chapter analyzes the existing system and its limitations, and presents the proposed system along with feasibility analysis (technical, economic, and operational).
- Chapter 3: System Design
  This chapter describes the overall system architecture and design components, including Data Flow Diagrams (DFD), Use Case Diagrams, ER Diagrams, and database design.
- Chapter 4: Methodology
  This chapter explains the development approach followed in the project, including phases such as requirement analysis, design, implementation, testing, and deployment.
- Chapter 5: Implementation
  This chapter details the actual development of the system, including module descriptions (Student, CR, Adviser), technologies used, and screenshots of the working application.
- Chapter 6: Testing and Results
  This chapter presents the testing procedures, test cases, and results to validate the functionality and performance of the system.
- Chapter 7: Features, Advantages, and Limitations
  This chapter highlights the key features of the system, its advantages over existing methods, and any limitations.
- Chapter 8: Conclusion and Future Scope
  This chapter summarizes the outcomes of the project and suggests possible enhancements for future development.
- Chapter 9: References
  This chapter lists all the sources and materials referred to during the development of the project.

Chapter 2
Software Requirement Analysis

2.1 Technical Feasibility

The proposed system is technically feasible as it is developed using widely used and reliable web technologies such as PHP, MySQL, HTML, CSS, and JavaScript within a XAMPP environment. These technologies are open-source, well-documented, and easy to implement for web-based applications.

The system does not require complex infrastructure or high-end configurations. PHP handles server-side logic, while MySQL efficiently manages structured data such as user records, item details, and claims. The frontend technologies ensure a responsive and user-friendly interface.

Additionally, the system follows a modular and scalable architecture, making it easy to maintain and extend in the future. Since all tools and frameworks are readily available and supported, the project is technically viable.

2.2 Operational Feasibility

The system is operationally feasible as it is designed for students and staff who are already familiar with web-based platforms. The interface is simple, intuitive, and requires minimal technical knowledge.

Users can easily:

- Report lost or found items
- Search for items
- Track status updates

The role-based system (Student, CR, Adviser) ensures smooth workflow and accountability without requiring complex training. The system automates most processes, reducing manual effort and making it efficient for daily use.

2.3 Economic Feasibility

The project is economically feasible as it uses free and open-source technologies. There is no requirement for expensive software or hardware.

- XAMPP is free for local hosting
- PHP and MySQL are open-source
- No licensing cost involved

The overall development and deployment cost is minimal, making it suitable for an academic project. Maintenance costs are also low.

2.4 Hardware Requirements

Component	**Specification**
Processor	Intel Core i3 or above
RAM	Minimum 4 GB (8 GB recommended)
Storage	10 GB free space
Operating System	Windows / Linux / macOS
Internet Connection	Required for testing (optional for local)
Display	Standard monitor

2.5 Software Requirements

Software	**Purpose**
XAMPP	Local server (Apache + MySQL)
PHP	Backend development
MySQL	Database management
HTML/CSS	Frontend design
JavaScript	Client-side scripting
VS Code	Code editor
Browser (Chrome)	Testing and execution

2.6 Functional Requirements

FR ID	Feature	Description
FR-01	User Registration	Users can register with basic details
FR-02	User Login	Secure login system
FR-03	Report Item	Users can report lost or found items
FR-04	Search Items	Users can search items by keywords/category
FR-05	Item Tracking	Track status (Reported → Claimed → Returned)
FR-06	Claim Item	Users can request to claim an item
FR-07	Verification	CR/Adviser verifies claims
FR-08	Dashboard	View all items in centralized system
FR-09	Notifications	Users receive updates on claims

2.7 Non-Functional Requirements

1. Performance: System should respond quickly and load pages within a few seconds.
2. Security: User data must be protected with authentication and controlled access.
3. Usability: Interface should be simple and user-friendly.
4. Reliability: System should function consistently without failure.
5. Maintainability: Easy to update and fix issues.
6. Scalability: Can support more users in future.

2.8 Risk Analysis

Risk ID	Risk	Impact	Mitigation
R-01	Data loss	High	Regular database backup
R-02	Unauthorized access	High	Secure login system
R-03	System crash	Medium	Error handling & testing
R-04	User misuse	Medium	Verification system
R-05	Low adoption	Medium	Simple UI design

2.9 Use Case Description

Use Case 1: User Registration

Actor: Student
Flow:
User opens system → Enters details → Registers → Login enabled

Use Case 2: Report Lost/Found Item

Actor: Student
Flow:
User logs in → Fills item details → Submits → Item added to system

Use Case 3: Claim Item

Actor: Student, CR, Adviser
Flow:
User requests claim → CR verifies → Adviser approves → Item returned

Chapter 3
Software Design

Software Design

Software Design is a crucial phase of the Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC) in which the overall architecture and structure of the system are planned and defined. It acts as a blueprint for the development of the software system by transforming user requirements into a technical solution.

In this phase, developers identify different components or modules of the system, define their functionalities, and establish how these components interact with each other. It also involves selecting appropriate data structures, algorithms, and design patterns to ensure that the system is efficient, reliable, and scalable.

Data Flow Diagram

A Data Flow Diagram (DFD) is a graphical representation used to illustrate how data moves through a system. It shows the flow of information between different processes, data stores, and external entities. DFD helps in understanding the system logically by focusing on the movement of data rather than the control flow.

In a DFD, the system is broken down into smaller processes, and the flow of data between these processes is clearly represented using standard symbols. It provides a clear visualization of how input data is transformed into output, making it easier to analyze and design the system.

3.1 Data Flow Diagram (DFD – Level 0)

The diagram illustrates the high-level flow of data within the Lost & Found Management System. It shows how users interact with the system and how data is processed and stored.

At the initial stage, a User (Student) interacts with the system by registering or logging in. Once authenticated, the user can perform key actions such as reporting a lost or found item, searching for items, or submitting a claim request. The input data provided by the user is sent to the system for processing.

The system acts as a central processing unit that manages all operations. It stores and retrieves data from the database, which contains records of users, items, and claims. When a user reports an item, the data is saved in the database and made visible on the dashboard. Similarly, when a user searches for an item, the system fetches relevant results from the database.

For claim-related activities, the request is forwarded to the Class Representative (CR) and Adviser for verification and approval. Based on their actions, the system updates the status of the item (e.g., *Reported → Verified → Claimed → Returned*). The updated information is then reflected back to the user.

Overall, the DFD Level 0 represents a simplified view of how data flows between users, the system, and the database, ensuring efficient and transparent management of lost and found items.

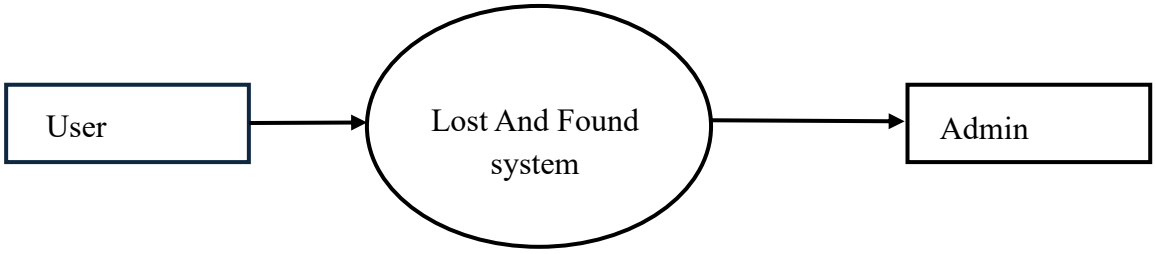

Fig 3.1: DFD Level 0

3.2 Data Flow Diagram (DFD – Level 1)

The DFD Level 1 diagram provides a detailed representation of the internal processes of the Lost & Found Management System, illustrating how data flows between users, system processes, and databases.

Initially, the User interacts with the system through the Authentication (1) process. The user chooses between Register or Login. If the user is new, they go through the registration process, which includes OTP verification, followed by login. After successful authentication, the user is directed to the Dashboard.

From the dashboard, the user selects an action under Choose Action (3), which includes:

- Add Item (to report lost/found items)
- Search Item (to find items)
- Claim Item (to request ownership of an item)

Once the user performs any of these actions, the data is processed and sent to the Submit Data module. This data is then stored in the system database, where it waits for further processing or approval.

On the administrative side, the Admin accesses the system through the Admin Panel (4). The admin is responsible for:

- Approving Items (stored in Items Database)
- Approving Claims (stored in Claims Database)

The system uses two main data stores:

- Items DB for storing item-related data
- Claims DB for storing claim requests

After admin verification and approval, the final outcome is processed, and the workflow reaches completion (End).

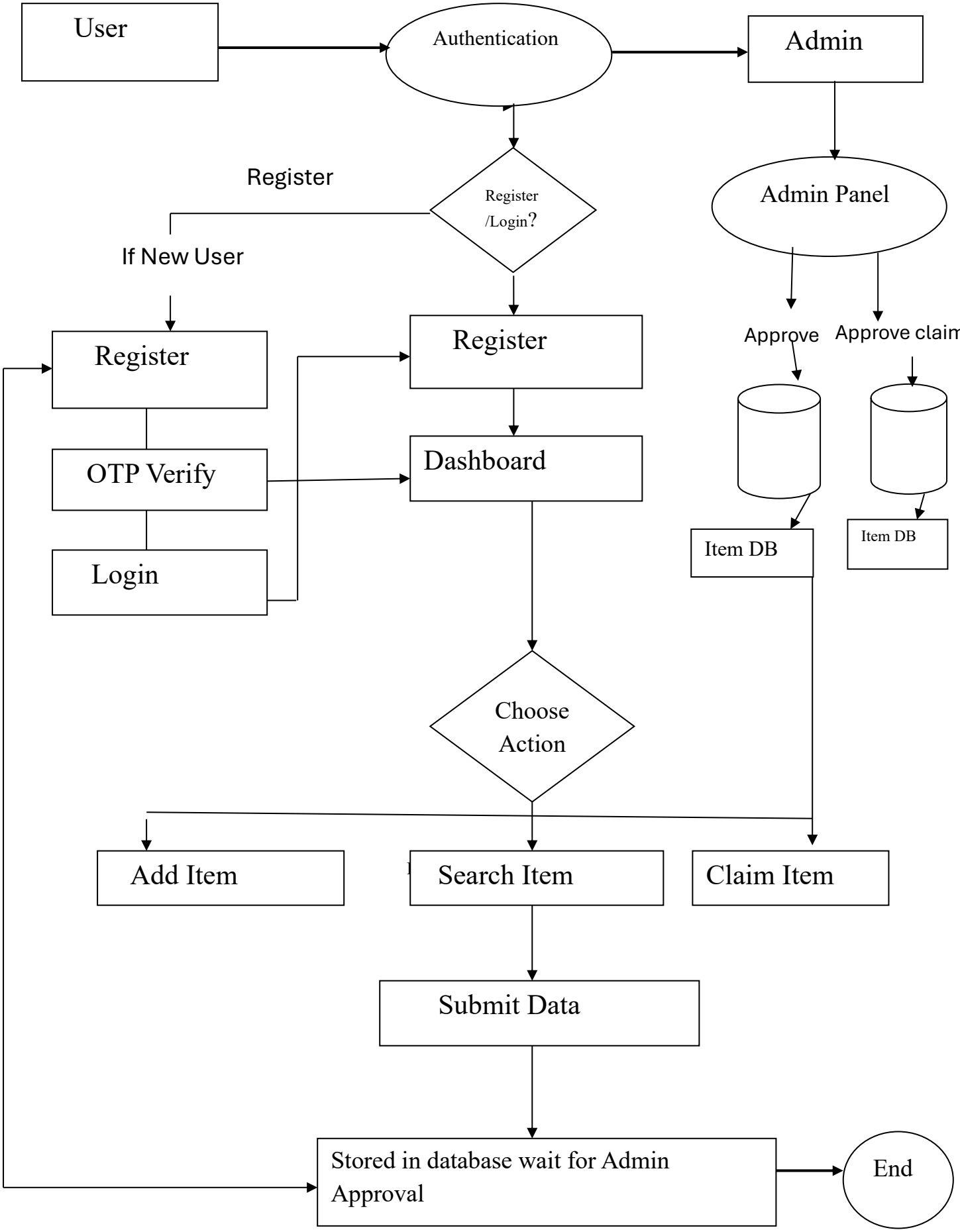

Fig 3.2: DFD Level 2

3.3 Flowchart Description

The flowchart represents the step-by-step working of the Lost & Found Management System, illustrating how a user interacts with the system from start to end.

The process begins with the Start node, after which the user is prompted to Login or Register. The system then checks whether the user is a new user through the decision "If New User?".

- If the user is new (Yes), they proceed to the Register process, followed by OTP Verification, and then move to the Login step.
- If the user is an existing user (No), they directly proceed to the Login step.

After successful login, the user is redirected to the Dashboard, which acts as the central interface of the system. From here, the system asks the user to Check Action, where the user can choose one of the following options:

- Add Item – to report a lost or found item
- Search Item – to find existing items in the system
- Claim Item – to request ownership of an item

Based on the selected action, the user either enters new data or views existing data in the Entry Data / View Data step. The processed information is then sent to the Submit Data stage.

After submission, the data is stored in the Database, ensuring proper record maintenance. The system then moves to the Wait for Admin Approval stage, where the admin verifies the item or claim request.

Once the verification process is completed, the workflow reaches the End, marking the completion of the process.

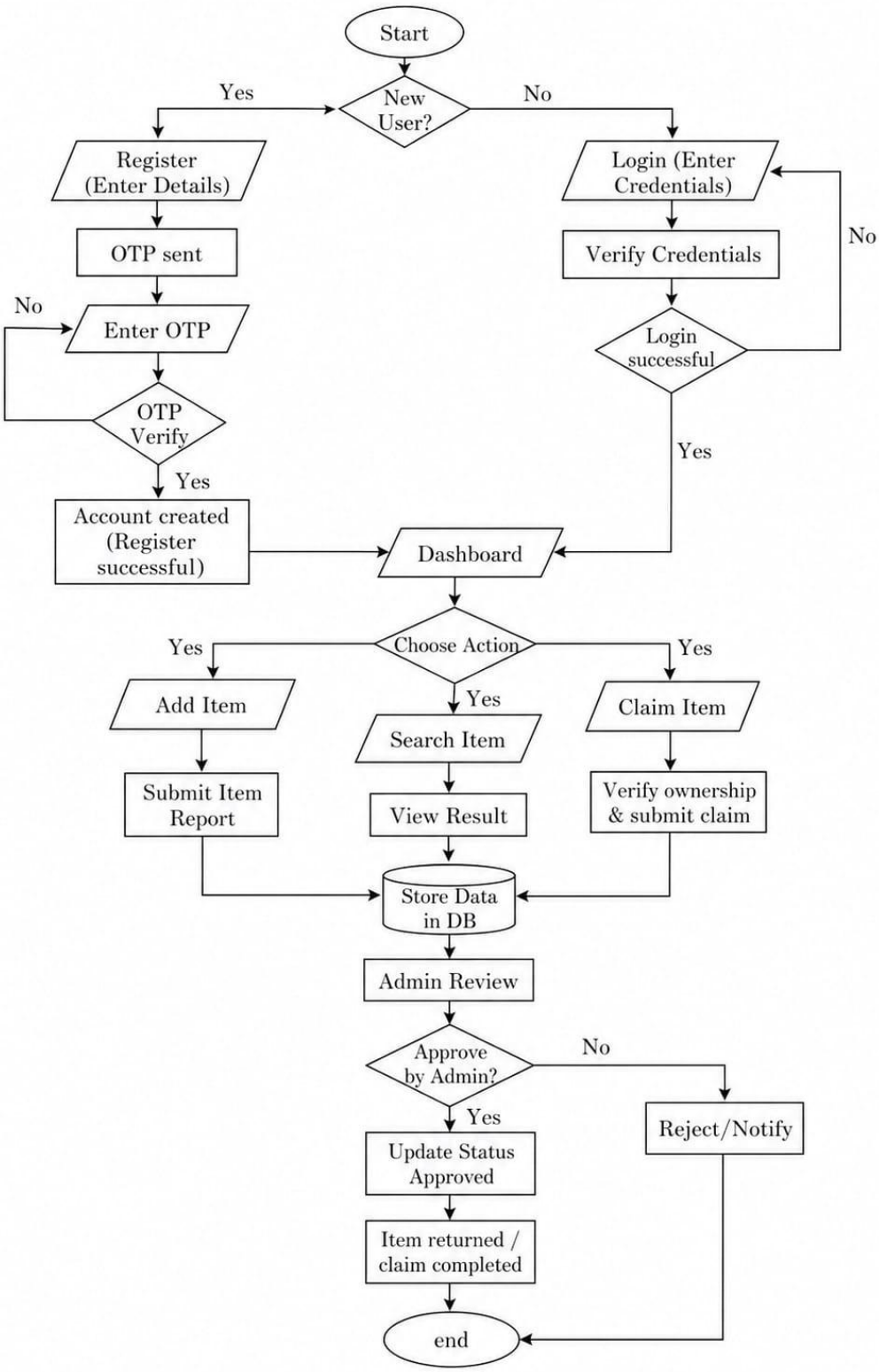

Fig 3.3: DFD Level 1

3.4 ER Diagram Description

The ER diagram represents the structure of the **Lost & Found Management System**. It includes key entities such as **User, Admin, Lost Item, Found Item, Match, and Claim Request**. A user can report lost or found items, which are stored in the system. The admin reviews and approves these items. The **Match** entity links related lost and found items based on similarities. When a user identifies their item, they submit a **Claim Request**, which includes verification details. The system then processes the claim, and upon approval, the item is returned to the rightful owner, ensuring secure and organized management.

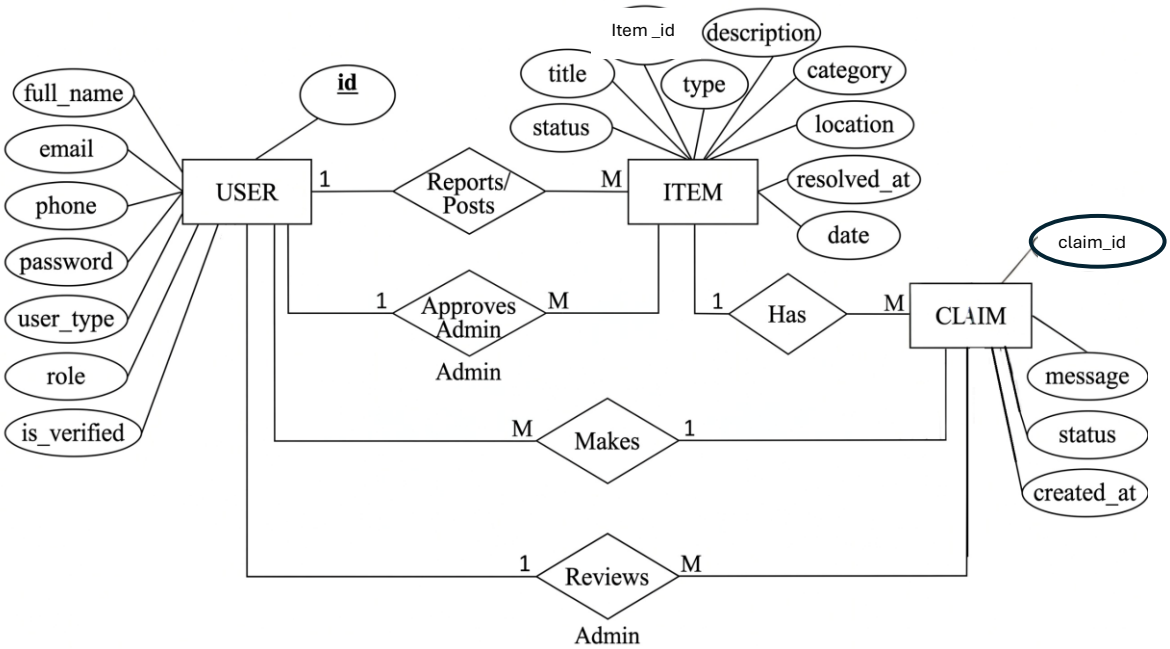

Fig 3.4 : Er Diagram

Use Case Diagram Description

The use case diagram illustrates interactions between Student, CR, Class Adviser, Admin, and System. Students can report, search, and claim items. CRs verify and update item status, while advisers approve claims. Admin manages users, items, and reports. The system database supports all operations and sends notifications.

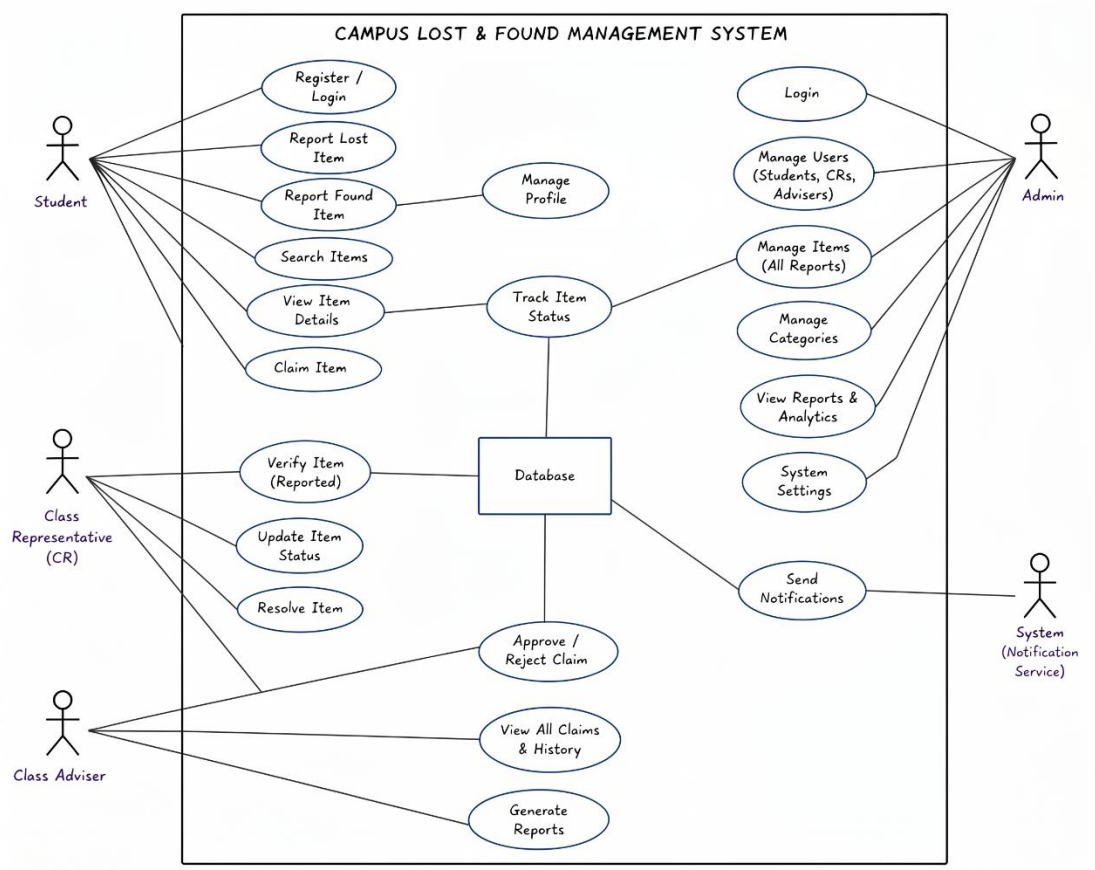

Fig 3.5 : Use case

Chapter 4
Implementation & User Interface

4.1 Implementation Environment

The implementation phase involves converting system design into a working application. The development environment is set up as follows:

1. Frontend Development:
   The user interface is developed using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript to create a simple, responsive, and user-friendly web interface.
2. Backend Development:
   The backend is developed using PHP, which handles all server-side logic such as authentication, item management, and claim processing.
3. Database Setup:
   MySQL is used to store and manage data including users, lost items, found items, and claims. The database is managed using phpMyAdmin.
4. Server Environment:
   XAMPP is used as the local server environment, providing Apache server and MySQL database support for development and testing.
5. Development Tools:
   VS Code is used as the code editor, and a web browser (Chrome) is used for testing and execution.

5.2 Key Modules Implementation

5.2.1 Authentication Module:

This module allows users to register and login securely. User credentials are stored in the database, and authentication is performed using PHP sessions. Only valid users can access the system dashboard.

5.2.2 Item Management Module:

Users can report lost or found items by entering details such as item name, description, category, and location. The data is stored in the database and displayed on the dashboard.

4.2.3 Search Module:

This module allows users to search for items using keywords or filters. The system retrieves matching records from the database and displays results instantly.

4.2.4 Claim Management Module:

Users can claim items by submitting a request. The request is forwarded to CR and Adviser for verification. After approval, the item is marked as returned.

4.2.5 Admin Module:

Admin can manage users, verify items, approve/reject claims, and view reports. This ensures proper control and transparency in the system.

4.3 User Interface

The system provides a simple and clean interface for easy interaction.

Key UI Features:

1. Login/Register Page: Secure access to the system
2. Dashboard: Central place to view and manage items
3. Forms: Easy input for reporting items / Report lost Item
4. Search Panel: Quick item lookup
5. Status Display: Shows item progress (Reported → Claimed → Returned)

Login Page Description

The Login Page of the **Lost & Found System** is designed to provide secure and user-friendly access to registered users. It serves as the entry point where users can log in to report lost items, track claims, and assist others in finding their belongings.

The interface features a clean and minimal design with a clear heading **"Welcome back"**, followed by a short description that explains the purpose of logging in. At the center of the page, a login form is displayed inside a card layout to maintain focus and improve usability.

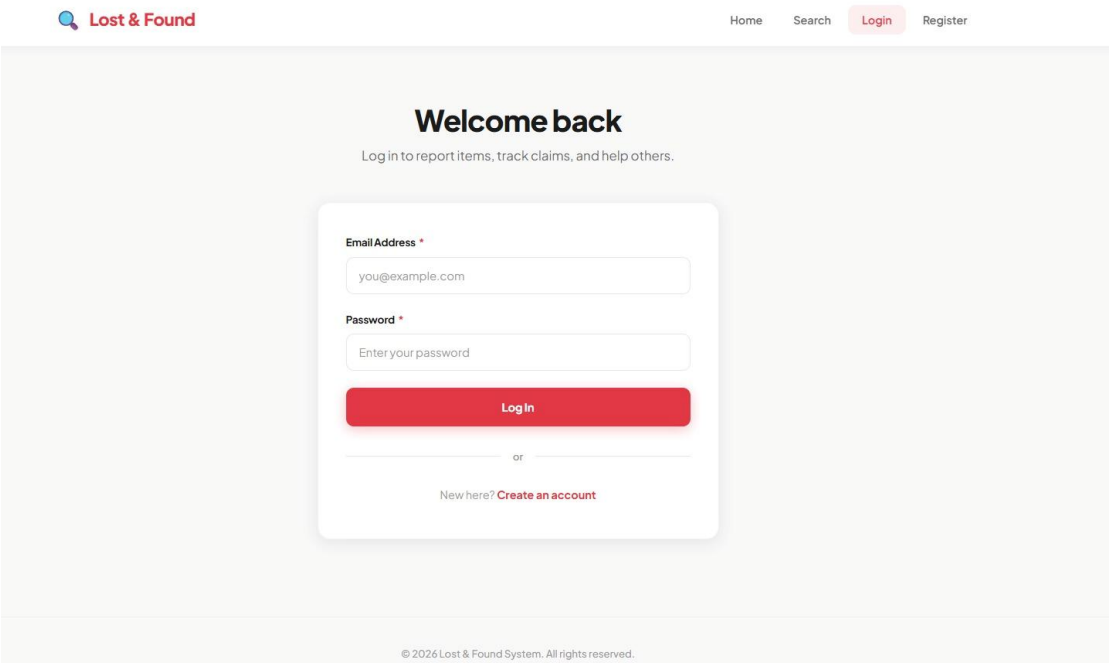

Fig 4.1 login page

Registration Page

The Registration Page of the *Lost & Found System* is designed to allow new users to create an account and become part of the platform. It provides a simple, structured, and user-friendly interface to collect essential user information required for registration.

At the top of the page, a clear heading “Create your account” is displayed along with a short description encouraging users to join the community to report and reclaim lost items.

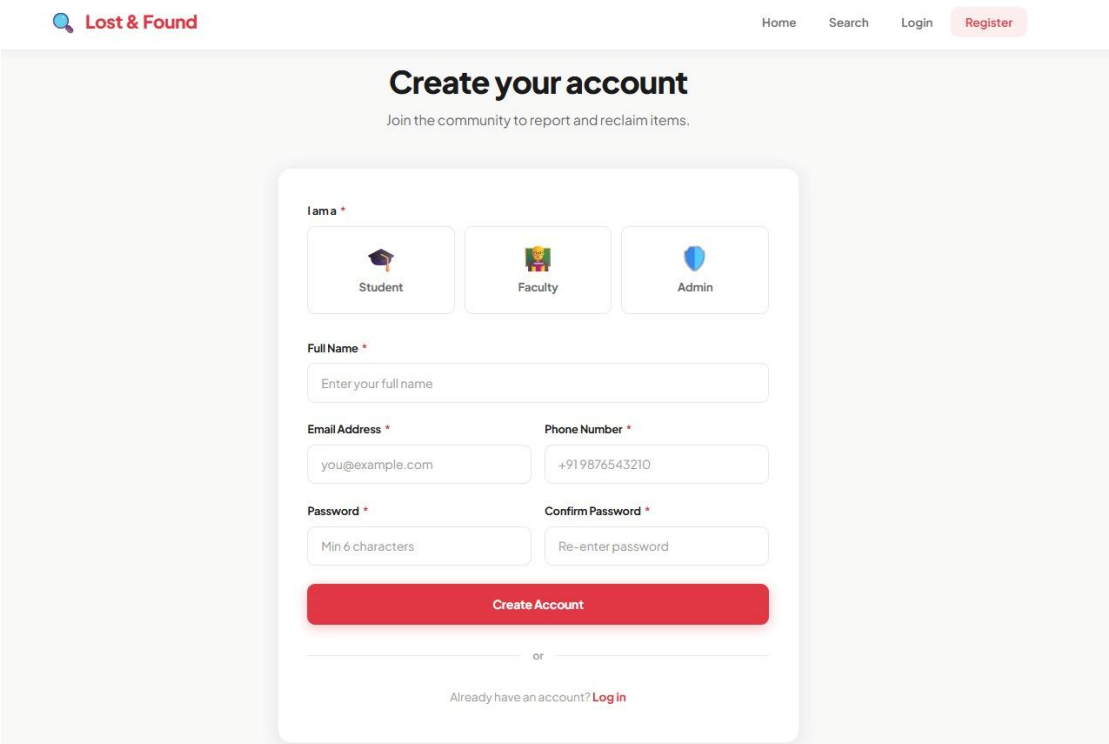

Fig 4.2 Registration Page

Dashboard Page

This dashboard page serves as the central hub of the Lost & Found system, providing users with an overview of reported items and quick access to key features. It highlights a prominent search bar that allows users to easily look up lost belongings such as wallets, keys, or phones. The page organizes items into categories like lost, found, for efficient browsing. Recently reported items are displayed in structured cards with essential details including item name, location, date, and status. The top navigation menu offers access to home, search, login, and registration, ensuring a smooth and user-friendly experience.

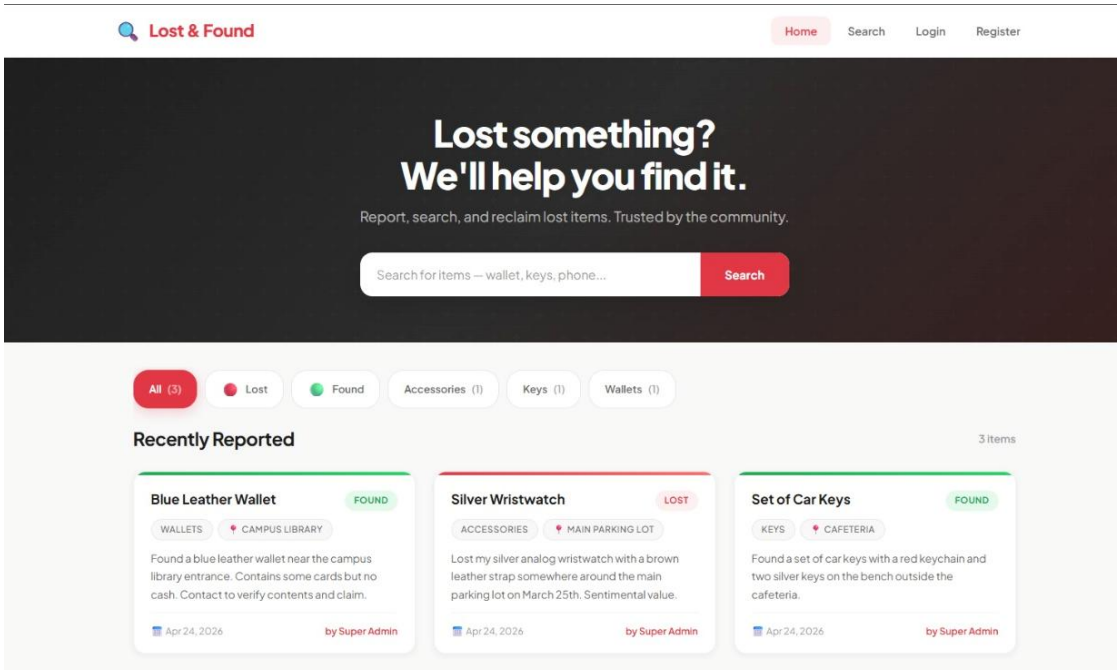

Fig 4.3 Dashboard

Super Admin Dashboard

This Admin Dashboard page provides a comprehensive overview of system activity for managing the Lost & Found platform. It greets the Super Admin and summarizes key metrics such as total items, pending approvals, lost and found items, claims, resolved cases, and registered users. The layout uses clean, visually distinct cards to highlight these statistics for quick monitoring. A “View Analytics” option offers deeper insights into system performance. Below, a detailed table lists all reported items, including their type, category, status, posting details, and available actions like resolving or deleting entries. The page is designed for efficient administration, enabling quick decisions and streamlined management of reports.

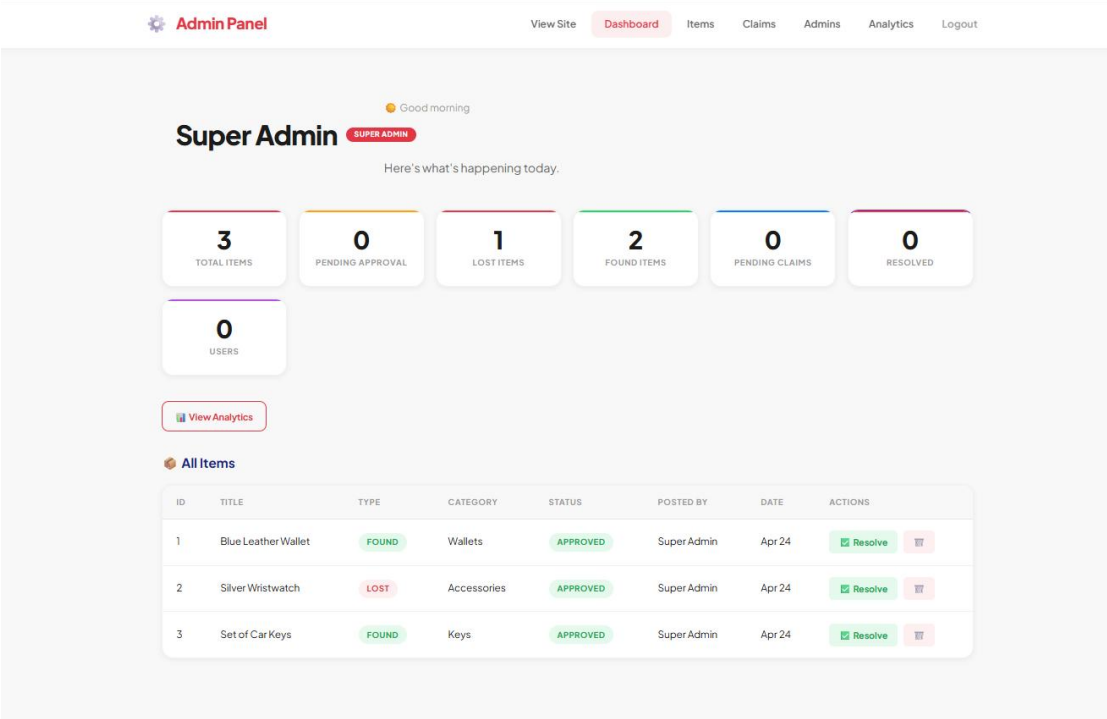

Fig 4.4: Super Admin dashboard

Report an Item Page

This page allows users to report lost or found items within the Lost & Found system. It features a clean and user-friendly form where anyone can submit item details, including title, category, type (lost or found), location, and a detailed description. A notification clearly informs users that all submissions require admin approval before becoming publicly visible. Once approved, the reported item appears across the platform dashboards, making it accessible to the wider community. The structured layout ensures easy input, while the submission process supports accurate reporting and helps improve the chances of reconnecting lost items with their rightful owners.

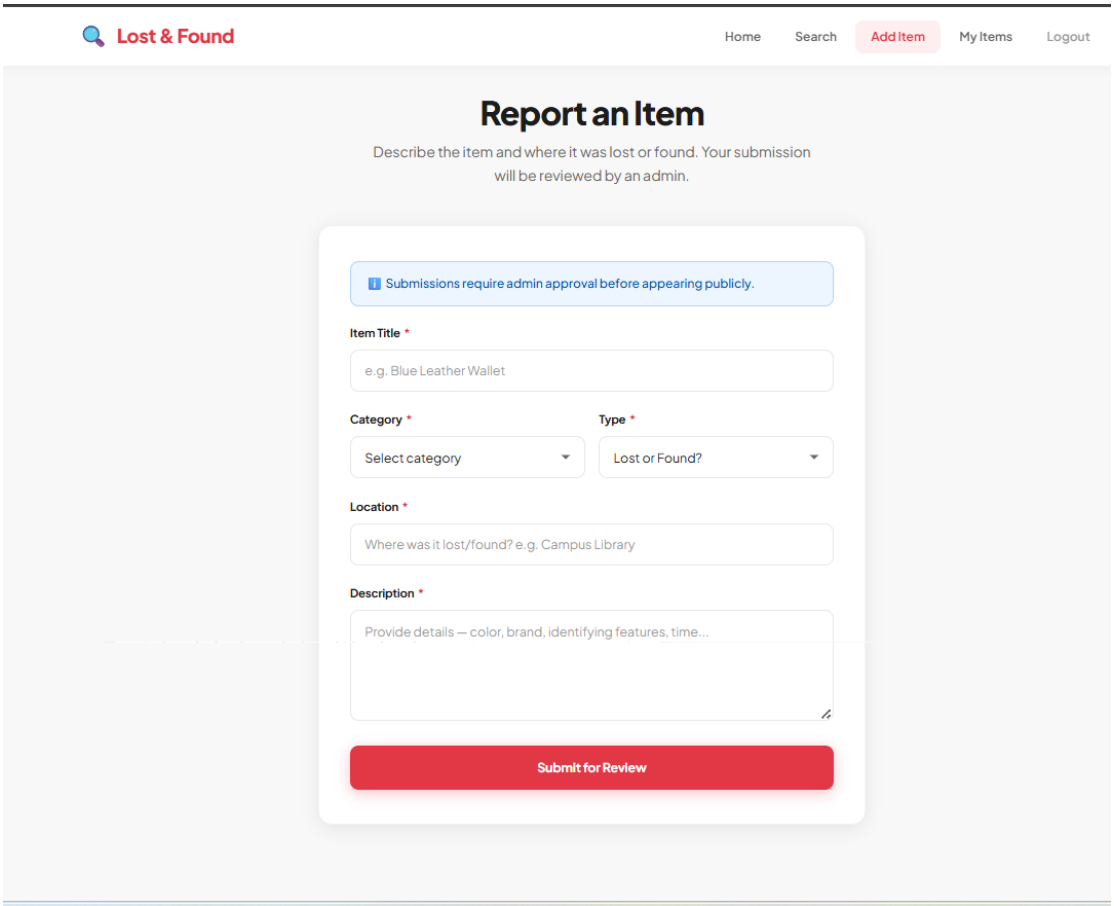

Fig 4.5: Report An Item

Chapter 5
Testing

5.1 Testing Overview

Software testing ensures that the system is functional, reliable, and meets user requirements. For this project, testing was performed using Unit Testing, Integration Testing, and Manual Testing.

Testing was conducted on a local system using the XAMPP server environment and web browsers such as Chrome to verify system performance and functionality.

5.2 Unit Testing

Unit testing was performed to check individual modules such as login validation, item submission, and search functionality.

UT ID	Module	Test Input	Expected Output
UT-01	Login Validation	credentials	Error message
UT-02	Login Validation	Correct credentials	Login success
UT-03	Item Entry	Valid data	Item added
UT-04	Search Function	Keyword	Matching results
UT-05	Claim Request	Valid request	Request submitted

5.3 Integration Testing

Integration testing ensures proper interaction between frontend, backend, and database.

IT ID	Scenario	Expected Result	Status
IT-01	User Registration → Database	Data stored correctly	Pass
IT-02	Login → Dashboard	Redirect successful	Pass
IT-03	Add Item → Database	Item saved	Pass
IT-04	Claim Item → Admin	Request sent	Pass
IT-05	Admin Approval	Status updated	Pass

5.4 Test Cases and Results

TC ID	Scenario	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
TC-01	User Registration	Account created	Success	Pass
TC-02	User Login	Dashboard opens	Success	Pass
TC-03	Add Item	Item stored	Success	Pass
TC-04	Search Item	Correct results	Success	Pass
TC-05	Claim Item	Request sent	Success	Pass
TC-06	Admin Approval	Status updated	Success	Pass
TC-07	Logout	Session ended	Success	Pass

Chapter 6
Conclusion

The project “Lost & Found Management System” has been successfully designed, developed, tested, and implemented. It effectively addresses the common issues faced in educational institutions regarding the management of lost and found items, where traditional methods like notice boards, emails, and messaging platforms are inefficient and unorganized.

By using PHP, MySQL, HTML, CSS, and JavaScript within a XAMPP environment, the system provides a reliable, centralized, and user-friendly solution. The application ensures smooth handling of item reporting, searching, claiming, and verification through a structured workflow. The role-based access system involving Students, Class Representatives (CRs), and Advisers enhances accountability and ensures secure processing of claims.

The system successfully resolves key problems such as lack of visibility, absence of tracking, and risk of false claims by introducing features like a centralized dashboard, real-time status tracking, and secure verification mechanisms. It improves communication efficiency and significantly reduces manual effort and delays.

The development of this project also provided practical experience in web development, database management, and system design. It strengthened problem-solving skills and understanding of real-world application development.

In conclusion, the project meets all its objectives by providing a secure, efficient, and transparent platform for managing lost and found items, thereby improving campus management and promoting trust and responsibility among users.

Chapter 7
Summary

7.1 Project Summary

This project started with identifying the major issues in traditional lost-and-found systems used in educational institutions, such as lack of organization, poor communication, and absence of verification. This led to the development of a centralized and secure Lost & Found Management System. The development was carried out in structured phases:

1. **Phase 1 – Requirement Gathering**: Identified problems in existing methods (notice boards, emails, WhatsApp) and defined system requirements like item tracking, verification, and centralized access.
2. **Phase 2 – System Design**: Designed system architecture using DFDs, Use Case Diagrams, Flowcharts, and ER Diagram to clearly define data flow and structure.
3. **Phase 3 – Development**: Developed the system using PHP, MySQL, HTML, CSS, and JavaScript in a XAMPP environment, implementing modules like login, item reporting, searching, and claim management.
4. **Phase 4 – Testing**: Conducted unit, integration, and manual testing to ensure all functionalities work correctly. All major test cases were successfully passed.
5. **Phase 5 – Documentation**: Prepared the complete project report covering all stages from analysis to implementation and results.

The final system provides features such as user authentication, item reporting, search functionality, claim verification, role-based access, and status tracking, making it a reliable and efficient solution for managing lost and found items in a campus environment

List of Symbols, Abbreviations and Nomenclature

Abbreviation / Symbol	Full Form / Meaning
CR	Class Representative
DB	Database
UI	User Interface
UX	User Experience
HTTP	HyperText Transfer Protocol
HTML	HyperText Markup Language
CSS	Cascading Style Sheets
JS	JavaScript
PHP	Hypertext Preprocessor
SQL	Structured Query Language
MySQL	Relational Database Management System
XAMPP	Cross-Platform, Apache, MySQL, PHP, Perl
CRUD	Create, Read, Update, Delete
ID	Identification
API	Application Programming Interface
URL	Uniform Resource Locator

Abbreviation / Symbol	Full Form / Meaning
Auth	Authentication
Admin	Administrator

Nomenclature (Project-Specific Terms)

Term	Description
Lost Item	An item reported missing by a user
Found Item	An item reported as found by a user
Claim	Request made by a user to retrieve a lost item
Verification	Process of validating ownership of an item
Dashboard	Central interface displaying system data
Status Tracking	Monitoring item progress (Reported → Returned)
User Role	Type of user (Student, CR, Adviser)

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